

Question:

A 6 year old girl is easily distracted in class and exhibits poor scholastic performance. Seizures are precipitated by hyperventilation. What is the probable diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Myoclonic seizures
- B. Absence seizures
- C. Atonic seizures
- D. Myoclonia

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To solve this problem , I need to look for patterns in the symptoms . The girl is easily distracted , which could be a sign of attention deficit disorder , and exhibits poor scholastic performance , which could indicate learning disabilities or other cognitive issues . Seizures triggered by hyperventilation are a key clue .

</thought>

<answer>

A . Myoclonic seizures </answer>

<thought>

However , the symptoms of a myoclonic seizure (a sudden , brief contraction of the muscles) do not fit the description of poor scholastic performance or distractibility in a 6-year-old girl . Hyperventilation-induced seizures are less common , but they are associated with absence seizures , which typically cause brief lapses of attention and lack of awareness rather than complete distraction . Atonic seizures do not fit the described symptoms since they cause sudden falls due to lack of muscle tone , not attention issues or poor academic performance .

</thought>

<answer>

B . Absence seizures </answer>

